

PROSPER AWUNI

Technical Cyber Security Engineer / Architect

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer and technical architect with strong hands-on expertise in Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender (including Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Defender for Cloud Apps), and KQL (Kusto Query Language) for detection engineering and threat hunting. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I have designed and implemented Microsoft Sentinel workspace architecture end to end, including data connector configuration, KQL-based analytics rules, automated playbooks, and reporting workbooks, and I have collaborated with outsourced Security Operations Centre (SOC) and Managed Security Provider (MSP) teams to continuously optimise the detection catalogue across cloud platforms and SaaS applications. I develop threat-led detection logic informed by threat intelligence and proactive threat hunting findings, and I bring a structured approach to analytical technique development that enables security incidents to be identified efficiently and reliably. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and have practical experience supporting ISO 27001 compliance activities and securing hybrid cloud and on-premises estates.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel:** End-to-end workspace design and implementation; data connectors (Azure Activity, M365, Entra ID, CrowdStrike, Syslog); KQL analytics rules and detection logic; automated playbooks (Logic Apps); reporting workbooks; detection catalogue management and optimisation
- **Microsoft 365 Defender:** Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for Cloud Apps — deployment, policy tuning, alert investigation, and incident response across 8,000-user estate
- **Detection Engineering:** Threat-led detection logic design; analytical technique development; coverage mapping against MITRE ATT&CK framework; proactive threat hunting using KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover — expert deployment, module management, and threat hunting
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure / Entra ID security posture; Conditional Access; monitoring coverage across cloud platforms and SaaS applications
- **Identity and Access:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO; BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune MDM and MAM, Tanium
- **Scripting and Automation:** KQL, PowerShell, SOAR playbook automation
- **Compliance and Governance:** ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, MITRE ATT&CK, JISC

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Designed and implemented Microsoft Sentinel SIEM workspace architecture including data connectors spanning Azure, M365, Entra ID, CrowdStrike, Syslog, and third-party feeds, ensuring complete telemetry coverage across cloud and on-premises environments
- Developed threat-led detection logic informed by threat intelligence sources and proactive hunting findings, authoring KQL analytics rules that identify security incidents with high fidelity and low false-positive rates
- Built Microsoft Sentinel automated playbooks using Logic Apps to orchestrate incident enrichment, analyst notification, and initial containment actions, reducing mean time to respond
- Developed automated reporting dashboards using Microsoft Sentinel workbooks, providing management with real-time visibility of security posture, detection coverage, and incident trends

- Collaborated with outsourced SOC and MSP teams to maintain and continuously optimise the detection catalogue, ensuring coverage across cloud platforms, SaaS applications, and hybrid infrastructure
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000-user estate, tuning policies, investigating alerts, and leading incident response as the senior escalation point
- Conducted proactive threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel KQL, mapping findings to MITRE ATT&CK techniques and translating results into new detection rules
- Supported ISO 27001 activities including control gap analysis, evidence collection, and security documentation, and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus compliance across the technical estate
- Ensured monitoring coverage across cloud platforms, SaaS applications, and on-premises systems, identifying and addressing telemetry blind spots in collaboration with infrastructure teams

University of the Arts London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Monitored, triaged, and investigated security alerts generated by SIEM and EDR platforms, applying structured analytical techniques to identify and prioritise genuine security incidents
- Contributed to Microsoft Sentinel data connector configuration, analytics rule tuning, and KQL query development to improve detection quality and coverage
- Supported the deployment and ongoing management of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across the UAL estate, including policy configuration, exclusion management, and alert investigation
- Conducted targeted threat hunting activities using Sentinel KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactively seeking indicators of compromise and adversary behaviour across endpoint and identity telemetry
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID and Azure AD, including Conditional Access policy updates and MFA rollout, strengthening identity-based controls across the estate
- Assisted with vulnerability scanning programmes using Nessus and Tenable.io, producing remediation reports and supporting tracking of vulnerability closure timescales
- Authored and maintained security response playbooks and analytical procedures, improving team consistency and response speed across common incident types

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Managed endpoint protection, patch management, and security monitoring tooling across the corporate IT estate, maintaining security baselines in a cloud-first SaaS and FinTech environment
- Administered identity and access management including Active Directory provisioning, access reviews, and role-based access control policy enforcement
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance activities including evidence collection, control gap analysis, and security policy documentation
- Managed MDM solutions for corporate device management and security baseline enforcement, supporting a hybrid remote and office workforce
- Monitored security events and escalated potential incidents, supporting initial triage and analysis activities for the security function

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and built UAL's Microsoft Sentinel SIEM architecture end to end, integrating data connectors across Azure, M365, CrowdStrike, and on-premises systems to deliver unified detection and visibility
- Developed a comprehensive detection catalogue of KQL analytics rules covering priority MITRE ATT&CK techniques, including identity-based attacks, lateral movement, and cloud threat vectors
- Built automated Sentinel playbooks that reduced analyst workload for routine enrichment and notification tasks, enabling the security team to focus analyst time on genuine incident response
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000-user estate, delivering coverage across endpoint, identity, and cloud attack surfaces
- Led UAL's Cyber Essentials Plus certification programme, co-ordinating cross-team remediation and supporting ISO 27001 audit evidence activities

- Deployed and tuned CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM alongside Microsoft Sentinel, enabling cross-platform detection correlation and enriched threat hunting capability

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering

B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)